

AIRLINE PILOT



SALARY

Newly qualified pilot ★★★★★
Experienced captain ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Industry run by a few large companies •
Demand slowing due to reduction
in low-cost airlines • Little chance
for part-time work

JOB DESCRIPTION

Piloting an aircraft is an exciting job that offers the chance to see the world. It is also a role that carries heavy responsibilities, as pilots are in charge of an expensive aircraft and must ensure the safety and comfort of the passengers. They also work to strict schedules and standards. Before they qualify, pilots must undergo a period of intense training in order to fly a commercial aircraft.



AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Aviation •
Mathematics • Physics • Engineering •
Travel and tourism • Computers •
Meteorology



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS
A pilot's license is required. Pilots
may train at colleges, private flying
schools, or through the armed forces.



LIFESTYLE Unusual working hours
go with the job, and pilots usually work
in shifts. They will often spend long
periods away from home.



LOCATION Travel is unavoidable.
Pilots on long-haul flights typically
spend a rest day at their destination
before flying home.



THE REALITIES Private training for
a pilot's license is costly, and there is
a lot of competition for good jobs. Pilots
spend most of their time in the cockpit.

CAREER PATHS

Earning a pilot's license is the first step toward a career as a pilot. With sufficient experience and flying hours, you can work toward becoming a captain. Pilots can work for passenger airlines, charter airlines, freight carriers, or private jet operators.

PRIVATE PILOT You can
train for a pilot's license with
a private flying school. It may
take 18 months to earn the
required flying hours.



ARMED FORCES PILOT If
you serve for a given period
of time as a pilot in the armed
forces, you may be able to
take a conversion course to
qualify as a commercial pilot.



GRADUATE A degree in aviation
studies or a similar subject will
help your chances of finding a
role with an airline company.

